

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

Latin American Studies (BA)

Students who complete the major in Latin American Studies will explore the region through three main avenues of study: (1) history; (2) economics, political science, and business; and (3) literature, language, and culture. Students are encouraged to specialize in one of these pillars while incorporating the program's multidisciplinary perspective.

At least one-half of the semester credit hours for a major must be taken at UT Dallas.

Courses in Latin American Studies are open to all students in the University.

Bachelor of Arts in Latin American Studies

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professors: Jennifer S. Holmes, Manuel (Manny) Martinez, Rene Prieto, Rainer Schulte

Associate Professors: Charles Hatfield, Monica Rankin, Shilyh Warren

Assistant Professors: Paula Cuellar Cuellar, Katherine Davies, Humberto González Núñez

Associate Professor of Instruction: Jeffrey Schulze

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours^{[1](#)}

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor and degree requirements)

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

[HIST 2350](#) Latin American Civilizations

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

[GEOG 2303](#) World Regional Geography

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses (see advisor)

II. Major Requirements: 39-45 semester credit hours

Introduction to Latin America Preparatory Requirement: 3-9 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[HIST 2350](#) Latin American Civilizations

Choose 6 semester credit hours from the following:

[LIT 2350](#) Close Reading

[HIST 3301](#) Historical Inquiry

Foreign Language Requirement: 12 semester credit hours of Approved Language

The language requirement is 12 semester credit hours, or equivalent, of the same language, usually Spanish, or another approved language of relevance to Latin American Studies. Students can petition the Program Head for exceptions. If the language credit is obtained without taking classes, twelve additional semester credit hours of Free Electives (upper-division or lower-division) can be taken by student.

Latin American Studies Major Core Courses: 6 semester credit hours

[LATS 3301](#) Latin American Literature²

Choose 3 semester credit hours from the following:

[HIST 3398](#) Colonial Latin American History³

[HIST 3399](#) Modern Latin American History³

Latin American Studies Major Electives: 18 semester credit hours

Students must complete courses from the following list in at least **two disciplinary areas**. Students must complete at least 9 semester credit hours in a **single** disciplinary area.

History Electives

[HIST 3391](#) Modern Mexico

[HIST 3398](#) Colonial Latin American History³

[HIST 3399](#) Modern Latin American History³

[HIST 4369](#) Topics in Borderlands History

[HIST 4359](#) Topics in Latin American History

[HIST 3397](#) Study Abroad in Latin America (may be repeated as topics vary)

Other [HIST](#) courses with emphasis on Latin America may be considered.

Social Sciences Electives

[CRIM 3319](#) Comparative Justice Systems⁴

[GEOG 2302](#) The Global Environment⁴

[GEOG 2309](#) Principles of Geospatial Information Sciences⁴

[GEOG 3359](#) Human Migration and Mobility⁴

[GEOS 2321](#) Geology, Resources, and Environment of Latin America

[PSCI 4348](#) Terrorism⁴

Other geographical, political, and economic courses with emphasis on Latin America may be considered.

Language, Literature, and Culture Electives

[LATS 3301](#) Latin American Literature²

[LATS 3302](#) Latin American Film

[LATS 3303](#) Latin Social Dance

[LATS 4329](#) Major Authors

3000 or 4000-level [SPAN](#) courses

[LANG 4348](#), [LIT 3319](#), and [LIT 3337](#) with Latin American related subtitles will be allowed.

III. Elective Requirements: 33-39 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 33 semester credit hours

Both upper-and lower-division courses may be used as electives

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Incoming freshmen must enroll and complete requirements of [AHTC 1100](#).

Minors

Students must take a minimum of 18 semester credit hours for the minor. Students who take a minor will be expected to meet the normal prerequisites in courses making up the minor, and should maintain a minimum GPA of 2.000 on a 4.00 scale (C average). Semester credit hours may not be used to satisfy both the major and minor requirements; however, free elective semester credit hours or major preparatory classes may be used to satisfy the minor. Core courses offered by the school may count as lower-division semester credit hours toward the minor. Topics courses must be approved by the school. The Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology will substitute courses as necessary. At least one-third of the semester credit hours for a minor

must be taken at The University of Texas at Dallas.

Minor in Latin American Studies

18 semester credit hours

Students must enroll in a minimum of two courses in Spanish or French at UT Dallas at the level determined by the language placement exam.

Latin American Studies Courses: 12 semester credit hours

Choose any four courses from the following:

[HIST 2350](#) Latin American Civilizations

[CRIM 3319](#) Comparative Justice Systems

[GEOS 2321](#) Geology, Resources, and Environment of Latin America

[IMS 3091](#) Regional Management Area Studies: Latin America⁵

[IMS 3V91](#) Regional Management Area Studies: Latin America⁵

[IPEC 4304](#) Political Economy of Latin America

[LANG 4348](#) Advanced Topics in Language

[HIST 3379](#) United States Relations with Latin America

[HIST 3391](#) Modern Mexico

[HIST 3397](#) Study Abroad in Latin America

[HIST 3398](#) Colonial Latin American History

[HIST 3399](#) Modern Latin American History

[HIST 4359](#) Topics in Latin American History

[PSCI 4331](#) Mexican Politics

[PSCI 4332](#) Latin American Politics

[PSCI 4348](#) Terrorism⁶

[SPAN 4364](#) Advanced Spanish Culture

Language Courses: 6 semester credit hours

Choose two courses from the following:

[SPAN 1311](#) Beginning Spanish I

[SPAN 1312](#) Beginning Spanish II

[SPAN 2311](#) Intermediate Spanish I

[SPAN 2312](#) Intermediate Spanish II

[SPAN 3363](#) Spanish Composition and Style

[SPAN 3311](#) Advanced Spanish I

[SPAN 3312](#) Advanced Spanish II

[SPAN 4301](#) Advanced Spanish Conversation

[FREN 1311](#) Beginning French I

[FREN 1312](#) Beginning French II

[FREN 2311](#) Intermediate French I

[FREN 2312](#) Intermediate French II

[LANG 3342](#) Advanced Language Instruction

[LANG 3348](#) Topics in Language⁷

1. Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

2. LATS 3301 is repeatable for credit; first completed attempt used for Major Core and subsequent attempts may be used as an elective.

3. Students may not count a major core course as a History elective.

4. Topics courses, CRIM 3319, GEOG 2302, GEOG 2309, GEOG 3359, and PSCI 4348 must be approved by the Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology before enrolling to ensure that the course subject matter is predominantly Latin American.

5. IMS 3091 and IMS 3V91 require IMS 3310 as a prerequisite

6. PSCI 4348 must be approved by the Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

before enrolling to ensure that the course subject matter is predominantly Latin American.

7. LANG 3348 and LANG 4348 must be French or Spanish language-based sections.

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